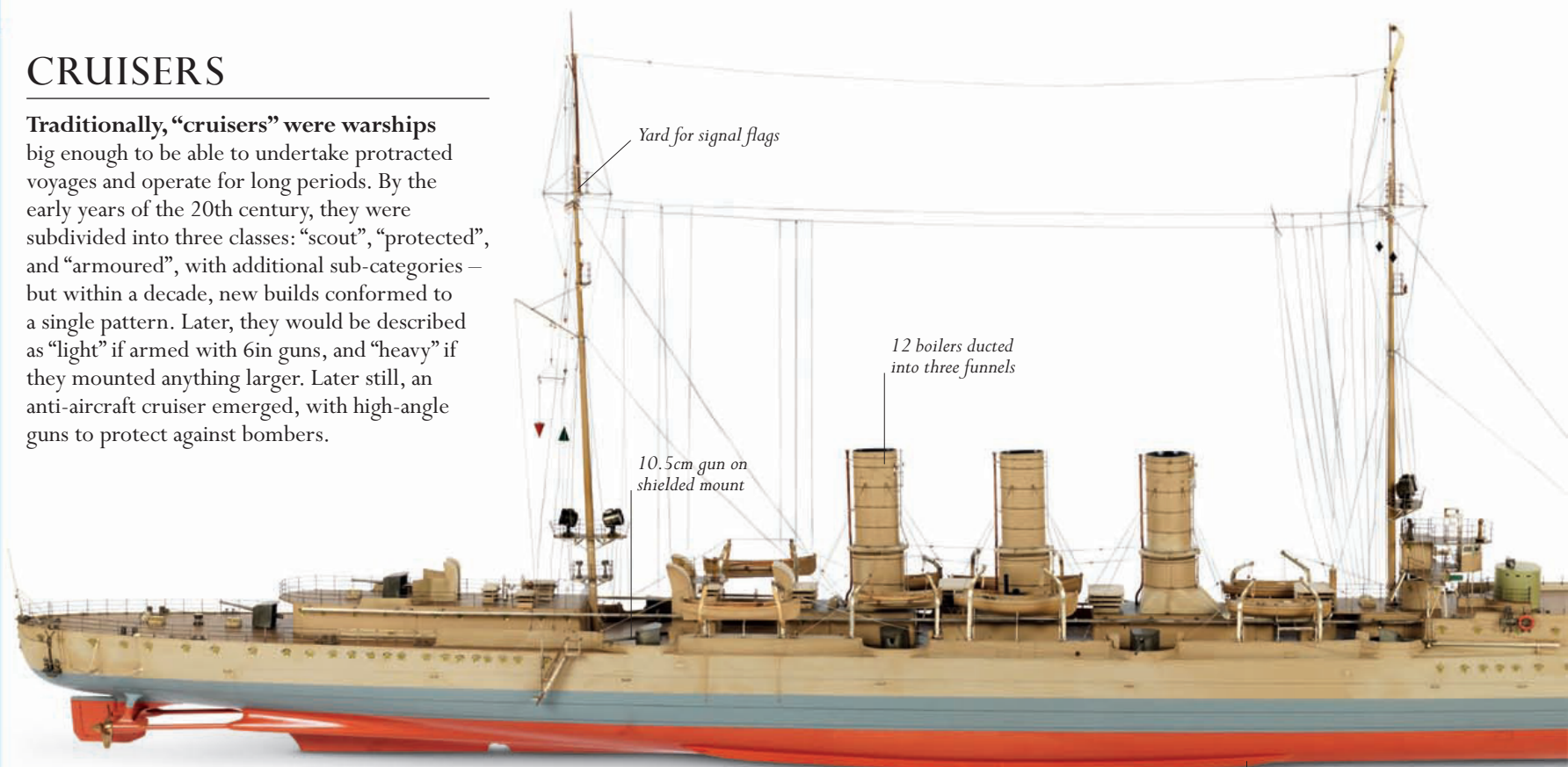


CRUISERS

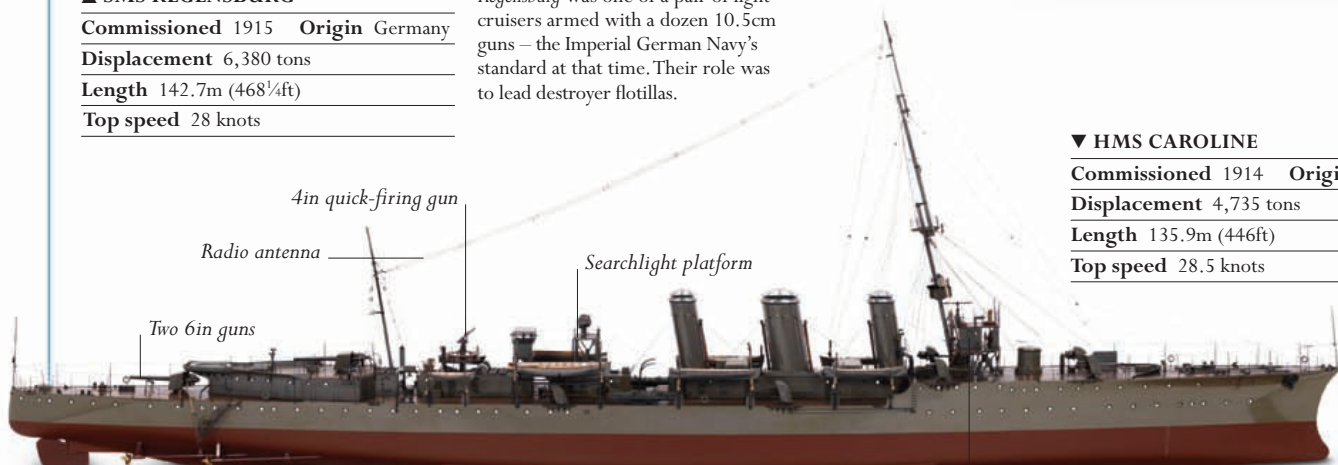
Traditionally, “cruisers” were warships big enough to be able to undertake protracted voyages and operate for long periods. By the early years of the 20th century, they were subdivided into three classes: “scout”, “protected”, and “armoured”, with additional sub-categories – but within a decade, new builds conformed to a single pattern. Later, they would be described as “light” if armed with 6in guns, and “heavy” if they mounted anything larger. Later still, an anti-aircraft cruiser emerged, with high-angle guns to protect against bombers.



▲ SMS REGENSBURG

Commissioned 1915 **Origin** Germany
Displacement 6,380 tons
Length 142.7m (468½ft)
Top speed 28 knots

Regensburg was one of a pair of light cruisers armed with a dozen 10.5cm guns – the Imperial German Navy’s standard at that time. Their role was to lead destroyer flotillas.



▼ HMS CAROLINE

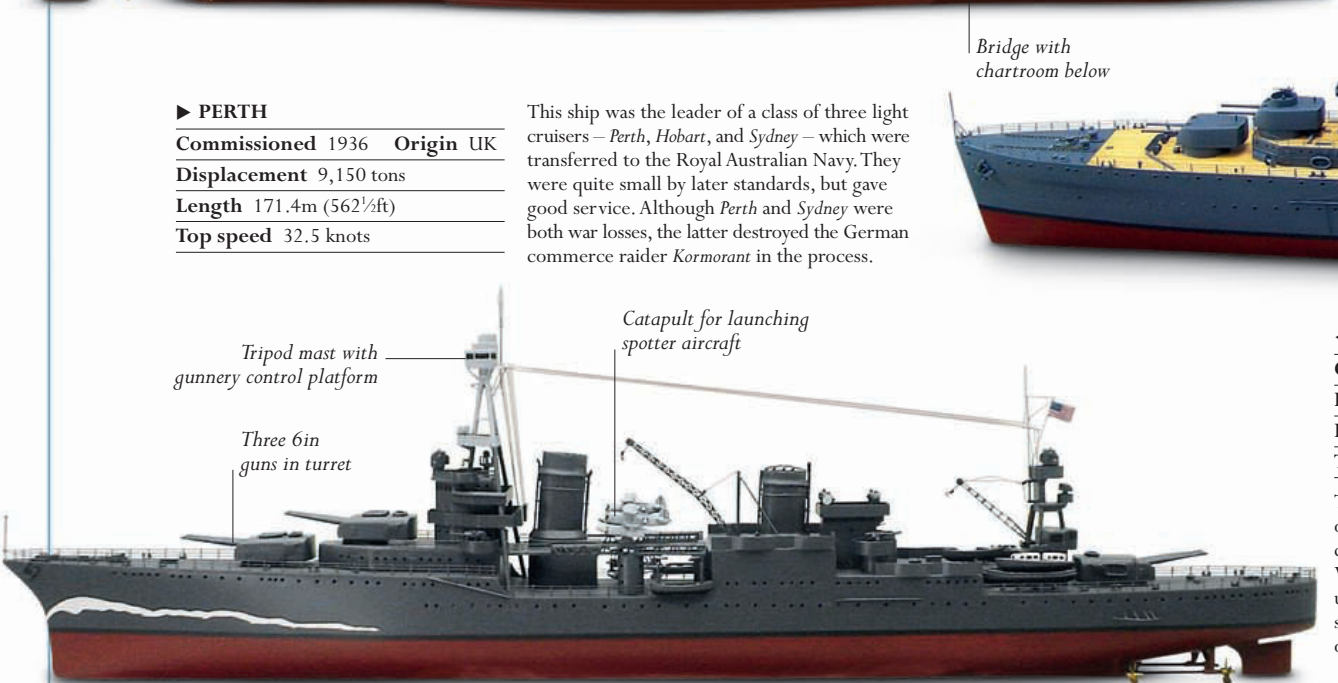
Commissioned 1914 **Origin** UK
Displacement 4,735 tons
Length 135.9m (446ft)
Top speed 28.5 knots

The lead ship of a group of six fast, light cruisers intended as destroyer flotilla leaders, *HMS Caroline* saw active service at Jutland. In 1924, it became a training ship at Belfast, Northern Ireland, where it remains today.

► PERTH

Commissioned 1936 **Origin** UK
Displacement 9,150 tons
Length 171.4m (562½ft)
Top speed 32.5 knots

This ship was the leader of a class of three light cruisers – *Perth*, *Hobart*, and *Sydney* – which were transferred to the Royal Australian Navy. They were quite small by later standards, but gave good service. Although *Perth* and *Sydney* were both war losses, the latter destroyed the German commerce raider *Kormoran* in the process.



◀ USS NORTHAMPTON

Commissioned 1930 **Origin** US
Displacement 11,420 tons
Length 183m (600¼ft)
Top speed 32.5 knots

The design of this leader of a class of six armoured heavy cruisers was compromised by the constraints of the Washington Naval Treaty of 1922. It was ultimately sunk by torpedoes during the short but hectic Battle of Tassafaronga on the night of 30 November 1942.

Bridge with chartroom below

Bulges improved stability